

Company: Incred Finance

Job Profile: **Business Analyst**

Offer Type: Internship + Placement

Internship Stipend: 25K/month

CTC: 12 LPA (11 + 1 Lakh Bonus)

Location: Mumbai

Process Date: 22nd July : Pre - placement Talk

23rd July : Resume Shortlist

24th July : OA (Online Assessment) + Interview

Placement Process:

The **information you gather from the pre-placement talk is extremely crucial** as it can make the difference between your selection and rejection. I tailored my resume, answered the interview questions and asked my own questions entirely based on what was said during the pre placement talk.

So take **screenshots of the PPT**, note down what points they talk about, and then try to think of questions to ask or topics to talk about based on your experience and their requirements.

1. **Resume Shortlisting**

We were asked to submit our resume on 22nd July, so I made changes based on what my seniors had done and what I felt were appropriate.

Make sure that you **tailor your resume** every time you apply for a different role. I had applied for 4 companies (2 on-campus and 2 off-campus) and I had a different resume for each. They do not have to be big changes, you might just change a project, or add different certifications or change your skills. Make sure that your **resume is consistent** throughout (Avoid using different date formats, using different bullet types or using Bold or Italics randomly).

After your resume is ready, check your **ATS score** from 'Resume Worded' : <https://resumeworded.com/>), **anything above 65** is good enough.

The results came out on 23rd July at around 6 pm, so instead of worrying about the results you need to prepare for OA and interviews.

2. **Online Assessment (OA)** [107 students appeared (approx)]

This was a 60 minute exam with two sections: Quant and Coding. It was a pen and paper test with 8 questions of **Quant which had a +3, -1 scheme**; 2 questions of Python/pseudo code and 4 questions of SQL.

I felt the quant round was easier as compared to other companies. I have shared all the relevant links in the end to help you prepare. In general the questions are: Find the age, work done and time taken, relative speed, probability and PnC.

The Python part was really just to see your **pattern recognition skills**. We had to find the sum of n terms of the series given. The first one was easier and of 1 mark : 0, 2, 6, 12, 20, 30..... The second one was of 3 marks with the logic : $[x^3 - (x+1)]$: -1,-1, 5, 23, 59, 119..... People were either unable to think of the logic or they forgot to find the sum and just wrote the logic. To avoid such mistakes, make sure you read the questions at least twice, once before solving the question and once in between.

The SQL round was of medium difficulty with four questions of 2 marks each. There were questions based on **Select, Join (Inner and Right), aggregate functions and Window** functions. I practiced SQL using Leetcode's SQL50 and watched a Youtube playlist.

Each **section had an individual cutoff** so you need to make sure you perform well in each section. I think 18/24 in Quant and 12/24 in Coding was the cutoff but this is just my estimate.

3. **Interview Round 1** [24 candidates were shortlisted]

This round lasted 15-20 minutes per candidate with 3 panels of 2 people each: one HR and one technical expert.

The questions asked were based **completely on the resume**, they enquired about each section, projects done, position of responsibilities, certifications and co-curricular activities. They asked a lot of questions on my major project which used Python for data analysis, where they also asked me to write down the formula for single linear regression and multiple linear regression. They also asked me why I chose to do each project and what could be their applications.

They also asked me some concepts based on statistics which I was not sure about - if such a situation arises, be very clear with them that you are not sure of the concept and take a short guess about what it could be. **Do not waste their time** by pretending to think or give an incorrect answer confidently.

Then they asked me why I was interested in this role, to which I answered by talking about different points throughout my resume. In their pre-placement talk, they mentioned that a Business Analyst needs to know all aspects of a business in order to derive insights for different projects. So, I tried to show them how I have covered all bases due to my committee experience, my projects and my certifications.

I also talked about how I liked the JD (Job description) of Incred specifically since it will be high impact work with high ownership. They asked follow up questions on how I know about this and I mentioned that it is **one of their values available on the website**. In the end, I asked them some questions about their upcoming IPO and how it will impact the day to day working of my job - this was done mostly to show that I had done my study on the company and am aware of their future plans.

The best way to approach such resume based rounds is by taking charge or **"breadcrumbing"**, where you end your introduction with a point that they would like to hear more about.

For example, at the end of my intro, I told them how I believe I am an ideal candidate for this position because of my Minors in Management from SPJIMR and asked them, **"May I elaborate on it?"**. After each

answer, I tried to add a point in the end that will lead them to ask me a question about something I know the answer to.

Some people were asked questions on writing a simple code for Pandas or Numpy since they mentioned it in their resume, so **make sure that you know each and every word of your resume**, why it is important and if there are any alternatives.

4. **Interview Round 2** [11 candidates were shortlisted]

I was first asked to **go through my resume** in detail, where I mentioned my Minors in Management from SPJIMR, my projects (the objective, tools I used, industrial application, relevance to the role applied), my committee experience (along with my learnings and relevance) and my case study competitions (the problem statement in short and my solution). There were a couple of follow-up questions on the Minors and about the case studies.

This was a **guesstimate based round**. I was asked how many units of electricity are consumed in India in one year. I was asked to assume that each electrical appliance consumes one unit of electricity in one hour. **I started by asking** whether I should just consider houses or industries as well. They told me to just consider houses. I then divided the whole problem into smaller parts, India into 4 tiers of cities and the year into three seasons. I also divided the population by 5 assuming that some families have 3 people but some have 6 or more so 5 is a fair guess. Then I made assumptions on how many appliances must be used in each household based on the tier of the city. I also made changes based on the season, for eg, there will be more lightbulbs used during winters since the nights are longer.

I was asked **some questions in between, unrelated to the case study**, like “Name 10 Tier 1 cities in India”. After this they asked me follow-up questions on what could be the potential factors for less electricity in tier 4 cities (Poor connectivity, cost, and poor infra maintenance), and how I will provide electricity to these cities and what factors I will consider (Coal power plants, nuclear power plants and alternate sources of energy), (Factors : long term environmental impact, cost per unit electricity, set-up cost of each plant, units of electricity required).

After this, I asked a couple of questions on how the use of AI can cause data security concerns and I finished the interview by asking, “If I am selected for this role, what should my roadmap look like to help me be better prepared for when I join?” - **This last question shows your excitement for the job and commitment to the company.**

A lot of other candidates were asked to take different approaches for their guesstimates, so you must know **several common ways to approach any problem**. The people who messed up their guesstimates were asked a case study question - for eg. what features would you add in GPay to make it better?

Interviewers care about how you approach any problem and not the exact answer - Just keep talking about why you are making any assumptions and what do you hope to achieve from it. Keep asking questions regarding the things you are not sure about and make sure that **you are confident in the approach you are taking**. Sometimes they may cross question you to judge your confidence, just justify your approach and make revisions if you think they made a good point.

In the end, **3 candidates were offered a job.**

Useful Tips:

I am attaching this [drive link](#) with the resume I applied with, along with other pdfs that might be relevant to your preparation.

I am also attaching [this link](#) where I have discussed my entire placement process, and what is the best way to prepare for Non-tech jobs, including how I made my resume, how to answer the questions - etc.

I have mentioned most of the relevant details above, but some general tips:

1. THE most important thing to remember is that there is always **a luck factor involved** in these processes - you might have done everything right but sometimes it just is not your day. You can either sulk and waste your time or try to learn from your mistakes, get an outside perspective and keep on learning.
2. **Be prepared for the worst**, the whole 'placement season' might be just 2 weeks but it might also be 6 months. Do not be anxious about the whole thing - just stay calm and hope for the best.
3. **Practice your Interview skills** a lot, even if you have excellent communication skills. I probably gave 10 interviews to my brother/ seniors/ roommates. I also probably took 30 odd interviews of friends and roommates. This is the only way to practice giving answers in a professional capacity.
4. The shortlist names are usually revealed just 15/16 hours before the interview or test, so **you need to prepare without worrying about the results.**
5. **Practice generic HR questions** - What are your short term and long term plans, plans for further studies (always SAY NO), etc - I will try to give an ideal response and in detailed answer in the doc attached above.
6. People either smile too much or don't smile at all, or avoid eye contact. All of these can negatively affect your chances.
7. **Be humble and show curiosity and eagerness to learn.** Don't let the interviewer think you are arrogant or a know-it-all.
8. Make a lot of projects - it is the **BEST way to learn new concepts** and it will allow you to pick and choose appropriate projects for each company to ensure you can put your best foot forward.
9. **DO NOT TRY to do everything all at once.** Almost all sources of studies/ projects are good enough if you complete them - but if you keep hopping from one source to another, you will end up with nothing done. Set strict deadlines to motivate yourself to finish your work.
10. Talk to your **seniors in your target company**, talk to people already **working in your target industry**, and talk to your **TPCs**, all of them can give you great insights and guidance not just for your placements but for your future career.
11. In case you wish to connect with me, drop me a text on [LinkedIn](#).

Skills and relevant links :

1. **Data Analytics:** [Alex the Analyst](#) - A complete Data Analyst Bootcamp(Python, SQL, Tableau, Power BI, Excel, AWS, etc), enough to prepare you for most analyst roles. **Completely free with a certificate** as well!
2. **SQL:** [SQL50](#) to practice questions
3. **Python:** For last minute Syntax revision:  [All Python Syntax in 25 Minutes – Tutorial](#)
4. If you are interested in **Finance:** [The Valuation School](#) is the BEST channel I can recommend, you can also make financial models to add in your portfolio. Other than this, read about terms from [Investopedia](#) - Will elaborate more on the doc shared above.
5. **Quantitative Aptitude:** Read R.S. Agarwal (Shared in the Drive), practice from [IndiaBix](#). For companies like JPMC - you should do CAT level questions.
6. **Case Studies:** The best way to learn Case studies is by **participating in actual competitions**, in the last year I participated in a LOT of competitions, all from Unstop. I think I made over 50 PPTs which directly or indirectly prepared me for a lot of questions, even guesstimates. I have also **shared a book** which helped me make better PPTs for my competitions. You can get other books as well if you just Google - Case study books IIM
7. **Guesstimates:** I never prepared for guesstimates from any fixed source - but I **maintained a book with a lot of information** that might help - India's population, Tier wise cities and population, gender ratio, population split by age, unemployment rate, inflation rate, etc. You should read/listen to a few case studies to understand how to approach the problem and how to talk about them. I will also share a very detailed approach to this in the doc.
8. **Puzzles:** I have been **watching riddles/puzzles** since my first year from [TED-Ed](#). - There are more riddles other than this playlist, you will find them all in the channel itself. TedEd will help you visualise your problems and help you understand how to approach such problems. Also practice the puzzles in [GeeksForGeeks](#) - It is the **best website to study anything related to coding** or for Job prep.
9. I also did some questions from [CodeForces](#) - it will help you develop logical reasoning - not necessary though.

BEST OF LUCK.

DON'T WORRY - IT WILL ALL WORK OUT IN THE END!